## READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27-40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

# On art and artists

**A** There really is no such thing as art, only artists. Once these were people who took coloured earth and roughed out the forms of a bison on the wall of a cave; today some buy their paints, and others design posters for hoardings; they did and do many other things. There is no harm in calling all these activities art as long as we keep in mind that such a word may mean very different things in different times and places, and as long as we realize that Art with a capital A has no existence: it has become something of an obsession. You may crush an artist by telling him that what he has just done may be quite good in its own way, only it is not true art.

**B** Actually, I do not think that there are any wrong reasons for liking a statue or a picture. We may like a painting of a village scene because it reminds us of home. There is nothing wrong with that. All of us, when we see a painting, are bound to be reminded of a hundred-and-one things which influence our likes and dislikes. As long as these memories help us to enjoy what we see, we need not worry.

**C** It is only when some irrelevant memory makes us prejudiced, when we instinctively turn away from a magnificent picture of an alpine scene because we dislike climbing, that we should search our mind for the reason for the aversion which spoils a pleasure we might otherwise have had. There are wrong reasons for disliking a work of art.

**D** Most people like to see in pictures what they would also like to see in reality. This is quite a natural preference. We all like beauty in nature, and are grateful to the artists who have preserved it in their works. Nor would these artists themselves have rebuffed us for our taste. When the great Flemish painter Rubens made a drawing of his young son, he was surely proud of his good looks, and wanted us, too, to delight in the child's appearance. But this bias for the pretty and engaging subject is apt to become a stumbling block if it leads us to reject works which represent a less appealing subject.

**E** The great German painter Dürer certainly drew his mother with as much devotion and love as Rubens felt for his child. His truthful study of old age may give us a shock which makes us turn away from it - and yet, if we fight against that first reaction we may be richly rewarded. For Dürer's drawing in its tremendous sincerity is a great work. The beauty of a picture does not really lie in the beauty of its subject matter. The trouble about beauty is that tastes and standards of what is beautiful vary so much.

**F** What is true of beauty is also true of facial expression. In fact, it is often the expression of a figure in the painting which makes us like or loathe the work. Some people like an expression - perhaps of suffering or of compassion - which they can readily understand, and which therefore moves them profoundly. But we should not, for that reason, turn away from works whose expression is perhaps less easy to understand. Often we must first learn to know the artist's methods of drawing to understand the feelings he or she wishes to portray, and may even come to prefer works of art in which expression is not obvious. Just as some of us would rather people use few words and gestures and leave something to be guessed, so some of us would rather look at paintings or sculptures which are open to interpretation.

**G** But here newcomers to art are often brought up against another difficulty. They want to admire the artist's skill in representing the things they see. What they like best are paintings which 'look real'. This is an important consideration, and the patience and skill which go into the faithful rendering of the visible world are indeed to be admired. Great artists of the past have devoted much labour to works in which every tiny detail is carefully recorded. Dürer's watercolour study of a hare is one of the most famous examples of this loving patience. But who would say that Rembrandt's drawing of an elephant is necessarily less good because it shows fewer details? Indeed Rembrandt gave us the feel of the elephant's wrinkly skin with just a few lines of his chalk.

**H** If we find fault with the accuracy of a picture, we must remember that artists may have their reasons for changing the appearance of what they see. We should also never condemn a work for being incorrectly drawn unless we are quite sure that we are right and the painter is wrong. We have a curious habit of thinking that nature must always look like the pictures we are accustomed to. For generations, paintings showed horses galloping with outstretched legs in full flight through the air, and we came to believe that this was indeed how they moved. It was only the development of photography which proved that horses simply do not gallop in that way. And yet, when painters began to apply this new discovery, and painted horses moving as they actually do, everyone complained that their pictures looked wrong.

*Questions 27-30*

*Reading Passage 3 has eight paragraphs,* ***A-H****.*

*Which paragraph contains the following information?*

*Write the correct letter,* ***A-H****, in boxes 27-30 on your answer sheet.*

**27** a comparison between people's preferences towards language and art

**28** why people may have misunderstood how a certain animal moves

**29** a contrast between the techniques used in two pictures

**30** a possible negative effect of using the term 'art'

*Questions 31–36*

*Look at the following statements (Questions 31–36) and the list of subjects below.*

*Match each statement with the correct subject,* ***A–G****.*

*Write the correct letter,* ***A–G****, in boxes 31–36 on your answer sheet.*

**31** The artist clearly hoped that we would share his admiration of this subject.

**32** The artist aims to give a general impression of this subject rather than a detailed one.

**33** Someone's personal experience may make them consider a painting of this subject unpleasant.

**34** The way in which this subject was once portrayed was factually wrong.

**35** The painting is well known for the effort the artist put into creating a very accurate picture of this subject.

**36** People may like a painting of this subject for a reason that is external to the painting.

**List of Subjects**

| | |
|---|---|
| **A** | village scene |
| **B** | alpine scene |
| **C** | Rubens's son |
| **D** | Dürer's mother |
| **E** | hare |
| **F** | elephant |
| **G** | horses |

*Questions 37-40*

*Complete the summary below.*

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

*Write your answers in boxes 37-40 on your answer sheet.*

## Beauty and expression

Differences in tastes and standards of beauty make it difficult to judge a painting. Dürer's painting of his mother is considered significant because it is a **37** _____ representation of her age and situation. However, we may need to overcome an initial reaction of **38** _____ when we see it.

In order to judge the facial expressions of people portrayed in a painting, we need to become familiar with the methods that the artist has used when creating the painting. While some of us are affected by the portrayal of a facial expression that we can **39** _____ without much effort, others prefer expressions that require **40** _____.

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## Questions 27–30

**题型：段落信息匹配 Which paragraph contains the following information?**

| 题号 | 答案 | 题干翻译 | 详细定位句 | 定位句翻译 | 详细解释 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 27 | F | 把人们对语言和艺术的偏好进行比较 | “Just as some of us would rather people use few words and gestures and leave something to be guessed, so some of us would rather look at paintings or sculptures which are open to interpretation.” | 正如我们当中有些人更喜欢别人说话时少用言语和动作、留一些内容让人猜测一样，有些人也更喜欢观看那些留有解读空间的绘画或雕塑。 | 这题找的是 “comparison between people’s preferences towards language and art”。关键词是 comparison / preferences / language and art。第 F 段最后一句非常明显：前半句讲的是人们对 “语言表达方式” 的偏好，后半句讲的是人们对 “绘画 / 雕塑表达方式” 的偏好，属于语言和艺术之间的类比比较。所以选 F。 |
| 28 | H | 为什么人们可能误解某种动物的运动方式 | “For generations, paintings showed horses galloping with outstretched legs in full flight through the air, and we came to believe that this was indeed how they moved. It was only the development of photography which proved that horses simply do not gallop in that way.” | 几代以来，绘画都把马画成四肢伸展、仿佛腾空飞奔的样子，于是我们开始相信马确实就是这样运动的。直到摄影技术的发展，才证明马奔跑时根本不是这种样子。 | 题干中的关键词是 misunderstood / how a certain animal moves。第 H 段明确说，人们之所以误解马的奔跑方式，是因为长期以来绘画把马画错了，人们便误以为那就是事实。这里的动物是 horses。所以选 H。 |
| 29 | G | 两幅画所用技法之间的对比 | “Dürer’s watercolour study of a hare is one of the most famous examples of this loving patience. But who would say that Rembrandt’s drawing of an elephant is necessarily less good because it shows fewer details? Indeed Rembrandt gave us the feel of the elephant’s wrinkly skin with just a few lines of his chalk.” | 丢勒画野兔的水彩习作是这种耐心细致风格最著名的例子之一。但谁能说伦勃朗的那幅大象素描就一定较差，仅仅因为它细节更少呢？事实上，伦勃朗只用几笔粉笔线条，就表现出了大象皱巴巴皮肤的感觉。 | 题干说的是 contrast between the techniques used in two pictures。第 G 段把两幅作品并列对比：一幅是丢勒的野兔，特点是细节极多、逼真细致；另一幅是伦勃朗的大象，特点是细节少，但用简练线条抓住感觉。这正是 “技法对比”。所以选 G。 |
| 30 | A | 使用 “art” 这个术语可能带来的负面影响 | “You may crush an artist by telling him that what he has just done may be quite good in its own way, only it is not true art.” | 你可能会毁掉一位艺术家——如果你告诉他，他刚刚做的东西也许自有其好，但那不是真正的艺术。 | 题干关键词是 negative effect / using the term ‘art’。A 段前面一直在说 “Art with a capital A” 这种抽象绝对化的 “艺术” 概念并不存在；最后一句进一步指出，若拿 “真正的艺术” 这种标准去否定别人，会打击 / 压垮艺术家。这就是 “负面影响”。所以选 A。 |

## Questions 31–36

**题型：匹配题 Match each statement with the correct subject**

**List of Subjects**
A village scene
B alpine scene
C Rubens's son
D Dürer's mother
E hare
F elephant
G horses

| 题号 | 答案 | 题干翻译 | 详细定位句 | 定位句翻译 | 详细解释 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 31 | C | 这位艺术家显然希望我们也能分享他对这一对象的欣赏。 | "When the great Flemish painter Rubens made a drawing of his young son, he was surely proud of his good looks, and wanted us, too, to delight in the child's appearance." | 当伟大的佛兰德画家鲁本斯画自己年幼的儿子时，他显然以孩子的美貌为傲，而且也希望我们同样为这个孩子的外貌而喜爱。 | 题干里的核心是 **artist hoped we would share his admiration**。定位句中 **wanted us, too** 是最强信号，表示"他也希望我们这样想"。对象就是 **Rubens's son**，对应 **C**。 |
| 32 | F | 艺术家想传达的是这一对象的整体印象，而非细致入微的描绘。 | "But who would say that Rembrandt's drawing of an elephant is necessarily less good because it shows fewer details? Indeed Rembrandt gave us the feel of the elephant's wrinkly skin with just a few lines of his chalk." | 但谁会说，伦勃朗画的大象仅仅因为细节更少就一定更差呢？事实上，伦勃朗只用几笔粉笔，就让我们感受到大象皱皮的质感。 | 题干关键词是 **general impression rather than a detailed one**。这里"shows fewer details"与"gave us the feel"对应得很明显：不是详细刻画，而是抓住整体感觉。对象是 **elephant**，对应 **F**。 |
| 33 | B | 某人的个人经历可能会使他觉得这类题材的画令人不快。 | "...when we instinctively turn away from a magnificent picture of an alpine scene because we dislike climbing..." | .....当我们因为不喜欢爬山，而本能地避开一幅壮丽的高山风景画时..... | 题干里的 **someone's personal experience** 在文中体现为个人偏好/个人联想影响审美。这里不是画本身不好，而是因为自己"不喜欢爬山"，从而对 **alpine scene** 产生排斥。对象为 **alpine scene**，对应 **B**。 |
| 34 | G | 这一对象曾经被描绘的方式在事实上是错误的。 | "For generations, paintings showed horses galloping with outstretched legs in full flight through the air... It was only the development of photography which proved that horses simply do not gallop in that way." | 几代以来，绘画把马画成四肢伸展、仿佛腾空飞奔的样子.....直到摄影技术的发展，才证明马奔跑时根本不是那样。 | 题干关键词是 **once portrayed was factually wrong**。第H段明确指出以前画马的方式与现实不符，被摄影证明是错的。对象是 **horses**，对应 **G**。 |
| 35 | E | 这幅画因艺术家为准确呈现这一对象所付出的努力而闻名。 | "Great artists of the past have devoted much labour to works in which every tiny detail is carefully recorded. Dürer's watercolour study of a hare is one of the most famous examples of this loving patience." | 过去的伟大艺术家曾在作品中投入大量心血，把每一个细小细节都认真记录下来。丢勒那幅野兔水彩习作就是这种耐心细致最著名的例子之一。 | 题干关键词是 **well known / effort / very accurate picture**。定位句中的 **every tiny detail**、**loving patience** 都体现了极高的精确度和投入。对象是 **hare**，对应 **E**。 |
| 36 | A | 人们可能因为画作之外的原因而喜欢这一题材的画。 | "We may like a painting of a village scene because it reminds us of home." | 我们可能喜欢一幅乡村景色画，是因为它让我们想起家乡。 | 题干关键词是 **for a reason external to the painting**，即"喜欢的原因不在画本身，而在画外因素"。这里"because it reminds us of home"显然是外部原因，是个人情感联想。对象是 **village scene**，对应 **A**。 |

## Questions 37–40

**题型：Summary Completion**

**Beauty and expression**

| 题号 | 答案 | 题干翻译 | 详细定位句 | 定位句翻译 | 详细解释 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 37 | truthful | 丢勒画他母亲的这幅画之所以重要，是因为它对她的年龄和处境作了一个 _____ 的呈现。 | "His truthful study of old age may give us a shock..." | 他对老年的真实刻画也许会给我们带来震惊..... | 概括句里说"representation of her age and situation"，原文对应的是 **truthful study of old age**。这里 **truthful** 最符合"真实的、忠实的"。注意不能写 **truthfully**，因为空格后面修饰的是名词 **representation**，应填形容词。 |
| 38 | shock | 然而，当我们看到这幅画时，可能需要克服一种最初的 _____ 反应。 | "His truthful study of old age may give us a shock which makes us turn away from it..." | 他对老年的真实刻画也许会带来一种震惊，使我们转身避开它..... | 概括句中的"initial reaction of ___"对应原文中的"give us a shock"。所以填 **shock**。这里也和后文"first reaction"对应。 |
| 39 | understand | 虽然我们当中有些人会被那种不费太大力气就能 _____ 的面部表情打动..... | "Some people like an expression ... which they can readily understand..." | 有些人喜欢一种表情.....他们可以很容易理解这种表情..... | 概括句中"that we can ___ without much effort"对应原文里的 **readily understand**。因为题目要求只填一个词，所以答案是 **understand**。 |
| 40 | interpretation | .....另一些人则更喜欢那些需要 _____ 的表情。 | "...some of us would rather look at paintings or sculptures which are open to interpretation." | .....我们当中有些人反而更愿意看那些留有解释空间的绘画或雕塑。 | 这里 summary 用的是"prefer expressions that require ___"。原文不是直接说"require interpretation"，而是说作品 **open to interpretation**。概括改写后，最合适的名词就是 **interpretation**。 |